



X-Games is using drones

The current winter X-Games are being filmed with a drone and ESPN may be the first international network doing so. <http://dgit.in/DroneCam>

Lunar XPrice Winners

Over \$5.25 million has been awarded to the five winning teams of Google's Lunar XPrize and \$30 million are still up for grabs. More here: <http://dgit.in/GLXPrize>

Tomorrow's tech

platooning, where multiple vehicles drive close together as single unit. Anyone who has used the Google Now service can imagine how the self-learning feature would trickle down to the company's cars. The key aspect here is efficiency. Autonomous vehicles will ferry you around faster while burning less fuel. On the flip side, a few of us still enjoy driving. Then there's the possibility that self-driven cars would be a hit with the jihadists, who would appreciate the option of taking the suicide bit out of suicide car bombing.

Hydrogen Fuel Cell Powered Cars

A hydrogen fuel cell powered car is, by far, the most revolutionary and disruptive new technology on the horizon. It even sounds perfect – as perfect as the mythical cold fusion to be honest. Consider Honda's FCV hydrogen car concept. It's a full-sized sedan that promises 480 kilometres on a single tank of hydrogen, with a refuelling time of five minutes and pure distilled water being the only emission.

It can even use the fuel cell to power a typical American home for six days. That probably works out to around to six Indian homes for a year. Let's put it this way – this is the car that frees us from our dependence on oil, potentially solves our potable water problem, and even takes care of power shortage. It's hoped that unrestricted water and power will be a reality in Delhi by 2022, but Honda's FCV can pretty much deliver it right about now. Wait a minute, did we just vote the wrong entity to power?

Honda's FCV isn't just a pipe dream. The car is scheduled to go on sale in Japan by next year. In fact, the Japan aims to put 6,000 fuel cell cars on the road by 2020 Olympics in co-operation with Honda and Toyota. The city of Tokyo has already earmarked \$385 million for the project. The question is: why hasn't the world ditched petrol for this apparent holy grail of renewable energy already?

Although hydrogen is considered the most plausible replacement for fossil fuels and the fact that it exists abundantly in nature, pure hydrogen doesn't occur naturally. Synthesising it is an expensive affair at the moment. More than 95



Let's all pray that hackers aren't able to relay seizureandy.com on our windscreens

percent of current hydrogen synthesis is driven by methane. The remaining five percent comes from renewable sources such as wind turbines, but that's inherently expensive at the moment.

However, the good news is that the cost of a fuel cell had fallen by 80 percent over an eight-year period and efforts are on to reduce dependence on fossil fuels for hydrogen synthesis.

Augmented Reality Enhanced Head-up Displays

A Head-Up Display is a term describing any device that relays information to the user's field of vision by the means of a collimator. The very first form of an

HUD was introduced as a German rifle sight. This was way back in the 1900s. In fact, Britain already had a working HUD implementation in its prototype fighter jets in the '50s.

Surprisingly, most commercial aircrafts have been undergoing certifications for HUD integration only in the last few years. That's about six decades after it was introduced in military fighter aircraft. Even the US Space Shuttle received the addition only recently.

The good news is that the technology is expected to trickle down to the humble car in a rather spectacular fashion. Anyone who had played combat flight simulators, or rather any videogame for that matter



Autonomous cars: the final frontier in the human pursuit of laziness.